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but the amount won't be as daunting as the money you'd be shelling out for a Blu-ray or HD-DVD player. The format, however, is more of an attempt to escape paying patent royalties on DVD players, and hasn't received much support from the movie studios. Why would Sony Pictures—one of the largest movie production houses in the world—use any format but its own Blu-ray?

Such novel and low-cost disc formats are likely

to get squished into oblivion by the Big Bad Corporations, who seem to be leaning more and more towards Blu-ray. Blu-ray drives and players made it earlier to the market and the discs are capable of a greater capacity than HD-DVDs; with growing support, it seems that Blu-ray will haunt our living rooms in the coming years.

Then again, maybe it's not the big movie studios who'll invade our homes... ☒

Look Ma, I'm On TV!

Programmed entertainment is so...

In another time and another world, the sight of a Hungarian fat guy bouncing to the sound of an obscure Moldovan dance number wouldn't have elicited little more than a giggle or two. Today, Gary Brotsma, to his own surprise and occasional dismay, is one of the Internet's biggest stars, and Numa Numa (the oddly catchy Dragosta din tei by O-zone) is an online anthem. Think about it—would you rather suffer the assault of miscellaneous *saas-bahus*, or watch an average-looking old bloke play Queen's *Bohemian Rhapsody* with nothing but his palms? (www.youtube.com/watch?v=IOyEw9bT8yQ, for those interested)

The Perfect Medium

Don't you wish you'd thought of YouTube? It's just such a *simple* idea—let users upload and share videos they've created with everyone, and see what happens. Plenty happened, clearly. Your friend uploaded a video, you went and lol-ed at it, figured out you might as well check out some of the other videos, liked them, got hooked, put up your own video, told a friend. The same thing happens to around 13 million users every month, and that all-powerful beast—the community—ensures that those that deserve it become Internet icons, and the mediocre get squished under its merciless feet.

In retrospect, it's easy to see why YouTube kicks hindquarter. We've all developed what can only be described as collective Attention Deficit Disorder (ADD)—we've always got multiple application and/or browser windows open and are chatting up a friend or two while we're at it. The thought of investing an hour and a half sitting in front of the PC watching a movie and not *doing*



anything is, well, strange. YouTube-esque user videos are perfect. They're short enough so you won't get that itch to [Alt] + [Tab] away to check your mail, and they're isolated units with no preceding or succeeding episodes, so there's none of that emotional investment that comes with watching your favourite serial—no aching for the next instalment. Most content lacks depth, so your grey cells aren't taxed much; it's just pure fun. If you feel like making your own, instant gratification awaits you around the corner. And finally, there's no schedule to be followed—all

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